

EDEXCEL INTERNATIONAL A LEVEL

WMA11/01 January 2025 Worked Solutions

Jan 2025 paper rebuilt with the worked solution after each question.

9

paper questions

WMA11

Pure 1

**Single-
paper
solutions**standalone IAL
route**Dr Eslam Ahmed**

Prepared for Dr Eslam Ahmed - eliteigcse.com

P1

PAST PAPER

WMA11/01 January 2025

Jan 2025 | 9 questions | 75 marks

9

questions

75

marks

Answers

worked solution
after each
question

Question 1

Integration

1. Find

$$\int \left(8x^3 - 6\sqrt{x} - \frac{2}{5x^3} \right) dx$$

giving your answer in simplest form.

(4)

(Total for Question 1 is 4 marks)

Worked Solution - Question 1

1. Rewrite with powers

$$8x^3 - 6\sqrt{x} - \frac{2}{5x^3} = 8x^3 - 6x^{1/2} - \frac{2}{5}x^{-3}.$$

2. Integrate term by term

$$\int 8x^3 dx = 2x^4, \int -6x^{1/2} dx = -4x^{3/2}, \text{ and } \int -\frac{2}{5}x^{-3} dx = \frac{1}{5}x^{-2}.$$

3. Write in simplest form

$$2x^4 - 4x^{3/2} + \frac{1}{5x^2} + c.$$

Final answer

$$2x^4 - 4x^{3/2} + \frac{1}{5x^2} + c.$$

Question 2

Straight Line

2.

In this question you must show all stages of your working.
Solutions relying on calculator technology are not acceptable.

Given that

- the point A has coordinates $(-2\sqrt{3}, 5)$
 - the point B has coordinates $(7\sqrt{3}, 8)$
 - the straight line l_1 passes through A and B
- (a) show that the gradient of l_1 is $p\sqrt{3}$, where p is a rational constant to be found.
You must show each step of your working.

(2)

The straight line l_2 is perpendicular to l_1 and passes through A .

- (b) Find the equation of l_2 , giving your answer in the form $y = mx + c$, where m and c are constants.

(3)

(Total for Question 2 is 5 marks)

Worked Solution - Question 2

1. Find the gradient of l_1

$$m = \frac{8 - 5}{7\sqrt{3} - (-2\sqrt{3})} = \frac{3}{9\sqrt{3}} = \frac{1}{3\sqrt{3}} = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{9}.$$

2. Find the perpendicular gradient

The gradient of l_2 is the negative reciprocal of $\frac{\sqrt{3}}{9}$, so $m_2 = -\frac{9}{\sqrt{3}} = -3\sqrt{3}$.

3. Use point A

l_2 passes through $A(-2\sqrt{3}, 5)$, so $y - 5 = -3\sqrt{3}(x + 2\sqrt{3})$.

4. Simplify

$y - 5 = -3\sqrt{3}x - 18$, hence $y = -3\sqrt{3}x - 13$.

Final answer

(a) gradient = $\frac{1}{9}\sqrt{3}$.

(b) $y = -3\sqrt{3}x - 13$.

Question 3

Simultaneous Equations

3. The population of a town was monitored.

Exactly 5 years after monitoring began, the population was 58 000

Exactly 10 years after monitoring began, the population was 65 000

Given that the population of the town, P thousand, t years after monitoring began can be modelled by the equation

$$P^2 = a + bt^3$$

where a and b are constants,

- (a) find the value of a and the value of b .

(3)

According to the model, exactly T years after monitoring began, the population was 85 000

Making your method clear,

- (b) find the value of T , giving your answer to one decimal place.

(Solutions relying entirely on calculator technology are not acceptable.)

(2)

(Total for Question 3 is 5 marks)

Worked Solution - Question 3

1. Use t equals 5

The population is 58 thousand, so $58^2 = a + b(5^3)$, giving $3364 = a + 125b$.

2. Use t equals 10

The population is 65 thousand, so $65^2 = a + b(10^3)$, giving $4225 = a + 1000b$.

3. Solve for b

Subtracting gives $861 = 875b$, so $b = \frac{861}{875} = \frac{123}{125}$.

4. Solve for a

$$a = 3364 - 125 \left(\frac{123}{125} \right) = 3241.$$

5. Use population 85 thousand

$$85^2 = 3241 + \frac{123}{125}T^3.$$

6. Find T

$$T^3 = \frac{125(7225 - 3241)}{123}, \text{ so } T \approx 15.938 \text{ and } T = 15.9 \text{ to one decimal place.}$$

Final answer

$$(a) a = 3241, b = \frac{123}{125}.$$

$$(b) T = 15.9 \text{ years.}$$

Question 4

Indices & Surds

4.

In this question you must show all stages of your working.
Solutions relying entirely on calculator technology are not acceptable.

(i) Given that

$$y = a^x \quad \text{where } a \text{ is a positive constant}$$

express, in simplest form, in terms of y and a

(a) a^{3x+1} (1)

(b) $\frac{5}{(3a^{1-x})^{-2}}$ (3)

(ii) (a) Use the substitution $p = 9^t$ to show that the equation

$$3(3^{4t+2} + 1) = 82 \times 9^t$$

can be rewritten as

$$27p^2 - 82p + 3 = 0$$
 (2)

(b) Hence solve

$$3(3^{4t+2} + 1) = 82 \times 9^t$$
 (3)

(Total for Question 4 is 9 marks)

Worked Solution - Question 4

1. Use y equals a to the x

$$a^{3x+1} = a(a^x)^3 = ay^3.$$

2. Rewrite the denominator

$$\frac{5}{(3a^{1-x})^{-2}} = 5(3a^{1-x})^2 = 45a^{2-2x}.$$

3. Write in terms of y

$$45a^{2-2x} = \frac{45a^2}{(a^x)^2} = \frac{45a^2}{y^2}.$$

4. Use p equals 9 to the t

$$p = 9^t = 3^{2t}, \text{ so } 3^{4t+2} = 9(3^{2t})^2 = 9p^2.$$

5. Rewrite the equation

$$3(3^{4t+2} + 1) = 82 \times 9^t \text{ becomes } 3(9p^2 + 1) = 82p.$$

6. Obtain the quadratic

$$27p^2 + 3 = 82p, \text{ so } 27p^2 - 82p + 3 = 0.$$

7. Solve for p

$$p = \frac{82 \pm 80}{54}, \text{ so } p = 3 \text{ or } p = \frac{1}{27}.$$

8. Return to t

$$9^t = 3 \text{ gives } 3^{2t} = 3^1, \text{ so } t = \frac{1}{2}. \text{ Also } 9^t = \frac{1}{27} = 3^{-3} \text{ gives } 2t = -3, \text{ so } t = -\frac{3}{2}.$$

Final answer

$$(i)(a) ay^3. \quad (i)(b) \frac{45a^2}{y^2}. \quad (ii)(b) t = \frac{1}{2} \text{ or } t = -\frac{3}{2}.$$

Question 5

Differentiation

5.

In this question you must show all stages of your working.
Solutions relying on calculator technology are not acceptable.

The curve C has equation

$$y = 4x^3 + \frac{2}{x} + 9 \quad x > 0$$

- (a) Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$, giving your answer in simplest form.

(2)

Given that

- the point P lies on C
- the line with equation $y = k - 5x$, where k is a constant, is the tangent to C at P

- (b) show that the x coordinate of P satisfies the equation

$$12x^4 + 5x^2 - 2 = 0$$

(2)

- (c) Hence find the value of k .

(4)

(Total for Question 5 is 8 marks)

Worked Solution - Question 5

1. Differentiate

$$y = 4x^3 + 2x^{-1} + 9, \text{ so } \frac{dy}{dx} = 12x^2 - 2x^{-2} = 12x^2 - \frac{2}{x^2}.$$

2. Use the tangent gradient

The tangent line $y = k - 5x$ has gradient -5 , so at P , $12x^2 - \frac{2}{x^2} = -5$.

3. Clear the denominator

Multiplying by x^2 gives $12x^4 - 2 = -5x^2$, hence $12x^4 + 5x^2 - 2 = 0$.

4. Solve for x squared

Let $u = x^2$. Then $12u^2 + 5u - 2 = (3u + 2)(4u - 1) = 0$.

5. Use x greater than zero

$$x^2 = \frac{1}{4}, \text{ so } x = \frac{1}{2}.$$

6. Find the y-coordinate of P

$$y = 4\left(\frac{1}{2}\right)^3 + \frac{2}{1/2} + 9 = \frac{1}{2} + 4 + 9 = \frac{27}{2}.$$

7. Find k

Since P lies on $y = k - 5x$, $\frac{27}{2} = k - \frac{5}{2}$, so $k = 16$.

Final answer

(a) $\frac{dy}{dx} = 12x^2 - \frac{2}{x^2}.$

(c) $k = 16.$

Question 6

Integration

6.

In this question you must show all stages of your working.
Solutions relying entirely on calculator technology are not acceptable.

The curve C has equation $y = f(x)$, $x > 0$

Given that

- the point $P(4, -5)$ lies on C
- $f'(x) = \frac{2x^2 + ax + b}{4\sqrt{x}}$, where a and b are constants
- the gradient of the tangent to C at P is 7

(a) show that

$$4a + b = 24 \quad (2)$$

Given also that $a + b = -9$

(b) find, in simplest form, $f(x)$ (7)

Curve C is transformed to the curve with equation $y = f(x - 3)$

Given that point P is transformed to the point Q ,

(c) state the coordinates of Q . (1)

(Total for Question 6 is 10 marks)

Worked Solution - Question 6

1. Use the gradient at P

At $x = 4$, $f'(4) = 7$. Since $f'(x) = \frac{2x^2 + ax + b}{4\sqrt{x}}$, we get $\frac{32 + 4a + b}{8} = 7$.

2. Show the required equation

$32 + 4a + b = 56$, so $4a + b = 24$.

3. Solve for a and b

Together with $a + b = -9$, subtracting gives $3a = 33$, so $a = 11$ and $b = -20$.

4. Rewrite f prime

$$f'(x) = \frac{2x^2 + 11x - 20}{4\sqrt{x}} = \frac{1}{2}x^{3/2} + \frac{11}{4}x^{1/2} - 5x^{-1/2}.$$

5. Integrate

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{5}x^{5/2} + \frac{11}{6}x^{3/2} - 10x^{1/2} + c.$$

6. Use P to find c

$$-5 = \frac{1}{5}(4^{5/2}) + \frac{11}{6}(4^{3/2}) - 10(4^{1/2}) + c = \frac{16}{15} + c.$$

7. State f(x)

$$c = -\frac{91}{15}, \text{ so } f(x) = \frac{1}{5}x^{5/2} + \frac{11}{6}x^{3/2} - 10x^{1/2} - \frac{91}{15}.$$

8. Transform P

$y = f(x - 3)$ translates the curve 3 units to the right, so $P(4, -5)$ becomes $Q(7, -5)$.

Final answer

$$(b) f(x) = \frac{1}{5}x^{5/2} + \frac{11}{6}x^{3/2} - 10x^{1/2} - \frac{91}{15}.$$

$$(c) Q = (7, -5).$$

Question 7

Graphs of Functions

7.

In this question you must show all stages of your working.
Solutions relying entirely on calculator technology are not acceptable.

The curve C has equation

$$y = \frac{2}{x} - k$$

where k is a **positive** constant.

(a) Sketch the graph of C .

Show on your sketch

- the coordinates of any points of intersection of C with the coordinate axes
- the equation of the horizontal asymptote to C

stating each in terms of k .

(3)

The line l has equation $y = -kx - 6$

Given that l intersects C at 2 distinct points,

(b) find the range of possible values of k .

(5)

(Total for Question 7 is 8 marks)

Worked Solution - Question 7

Topic group

1. Identify the horizontal asymptote

$y = \frac{2}{x} - k$ has horizontal asymptote $y = -k$.

2. Find axis intersections

Setting $y = 0$ gives $\frac{2}{x} = k$, so $x = \frac{2}{k}$. There is no y-intercept because $x = 0$ is not in the domain.

3. Set up line-curve intersections

$$\frac{2}{x} - k = -kx - 6.$$

4. Form a quadratic

Multiplying by x gives $2 - kx = -kx^2 - 6x$, so $kx^2 + (6 - k)x + 2 = 0$.

5. Use two distinct intersections

For two distinct points, the discriminant must be positive.

6. Solve the inequality

$(6 - k)^2 - 8k > 0$, so $k^2 - 20k + 36 > 0$. Since
 $k^2 - 20k + 36 = (k - 2)(k - 18)$, $k < 2$ or $k > 18$.

7. Use k positive

As $k > 0$, the range is \$018\$.

Final answer

(a) x-intercept $(\frac{2}{k}, 0)$, no y-intercept, horizontal asymptote $y = -k$.

(b) 0.18.

Question 8

Radians

8.

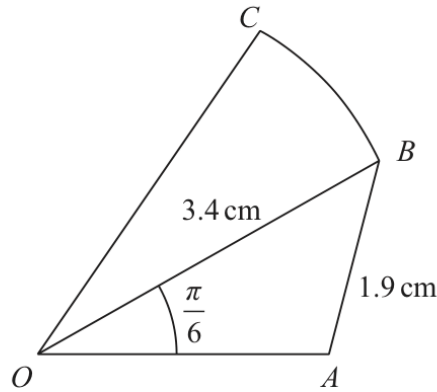


Figure 1

Figure 1 shows a sketch of a design for a badge.

The design consists of a triangle OAB joined to a sector OBC of a circle with centre O . In the design

- $OB = 3.4$ cm
- $AB = 1.9$ cm
- angle $AOB = \frac{\pi}{6}$ radians
- angle $OAB > \frac{\pi}{2}$ radians

Making your method clear,

(a) find the size of angle OAB , giving your answer in radians to 4 significant figures, (3)

(b) find the area of triangle OAB , in cm^2 , giving your answer to 3 significant figures. (2)

Given that the ratio of the area of sector OBC to the area of triangle OAB is 3 : 2

(c) show that angle BOC is 0.462 radians to 3 significant figures. (3)

(d) Hence find the perimeter of the badge, in cm, to the nearest integer. (5)

(Total for Question 8 is 13 marks)

Worked Solution - Question 8

1. Use the sine rule

In triangle OAB , $AB = 1.9$, $OB = 3.4$ and $\angle AOB = \frac{\pi}{6}$.

2. Find sine of angle OAB

$$\frac{\sin \angle OAB}{3.4} = \frac{\sin(\pi/6)}{1.9}, \text{ so } \sin \angle OAB = \frac{17}{19}.$$

3. Choose the obtuse angle

Since $\angle OAB > \frac{\pi}{2}$, $\angle OAB = \pi - \sin^{-1}\left(\frac{17}{19}\right) \approx 2.034$ radians.

4. Find OA

Using the sine rule again, $OA \approx 2.096$ cm.

5. Find the triangle area

$$\text{Area } OAB = \frac{1}{2}(OA)(OB) \sin(\pi/6) \approx 1.78 \text{ cm}^2.$$

6. Use the area ratio

Area sector OBC : Area triangle $OAB = 3 : 2$, so sector area
 $= \frac{3}{2}(1.78156\dots).$

7. Find angle BOC

$$\frac{1}{2}(3.4)^2\theta = \frac{3}{2}(1.78156\dots), \text{ so } \theta \approx 0.462 \text{ radians.}$$

8. Find the perimeter

The perimeter is

$$OA + AB + OC + \text{arc } BC = 2.096 + 1.9 + 3.4 + 3.4(0.46234\dots) \approx 8.968 \text{ cm.}$$

9. Round

The perimeter is 9 cm to the nearest integer.

Final answer

(a) $\angle OAB = 2.034$ radians.

(b) 1.78 cm^2 .

(c) $\angle BOC = 0.462$ radians.

(d) 9 cm.

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13 marks

Question 9

Trigonometric Functions

9.

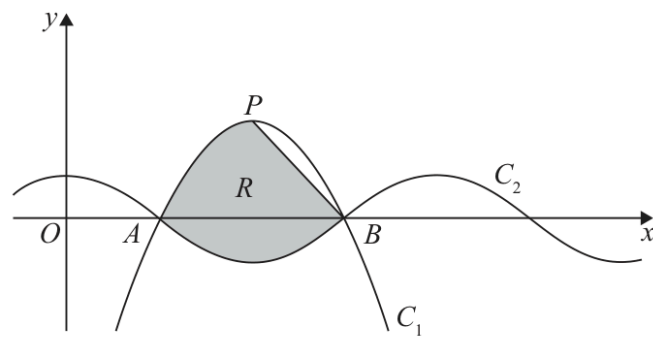


Figure 2

- (a) Express $6x - \frac{27}{4} - x^2$ in the form $a + b(x + c)^2$ where a , b and c are constants to be found.

(3)

Figure 2 shows part of a sketch of curve C_1 with equation

$$y = 6x - \frac{27}{4} - x^2$$

Given that the point P is the maximum point on C_1

- (b) state the coordinates of P

(2)

Figure 2 also shows part of a sketch of curve C_2 with equation

$$y = \cos(kx)$$

where k is a constant and x is measured in radians.

Given that C_1 and C_2 intersect on the x -axis at point A and at point B , as shown in Figure 2,

- (c) (i) state the x coordinate of B
 (ii) state the value of k
 (iii) state the period of C_2

(3)

The line segment L joins P and B .

The region R , shown shaded in Figure 2, is bounded by L , C_1 and C_2

- (d) Use inequalities to define R .

(5)

(Total for Question 9 is 13 marks)

Worked Solution - Question 9

1. Complete the square

$$6x - \frac{27}{4} - x^2 = -(x^2 - 6x) - \frac{27}{4} = -(x - 3)^2 + 9 - \frac{27}{4}.$$

2. State the completed-square form

$$6x - \frac{27}{4} - x^2 = \frac{9}{4} - (x - 3)^2.$$

3. Find the maximum point

The maximum point is $P = (3, \frac{9}{4})$.

4. Find the x-intercepts of C1

$\frac{9}{4} - (x - 3)^2 = 0$ gives $x = 3 \pm \frac{3}{2}$. Hence A has $x = \frac{3}{2}$ and B has $x = \frac{9}{2}$.

5. Use consecutive zeros of cosine

The distance between consecutive zeros of $\cos(kx)$ is $\frac{\pi}{k}$.

6. Find k and the period

Since $x_B - x_A = \frac{9}{2} - \frac{3}{2} = 3$, $\frac{\pi}{k} = 3$, so $k = \frac{\pi}{3}$. The period is $\frac{2\pi}{k} = 6$.

7. Find the line through P and B

The line through $P(3, \frac{9}{4})$ and $B(\frac{9}{2}, 0)$ has gradient $-\frac{3}{2}$, so L is

$$y = -\frac{3}{2}x + \frac{27}{4}.$$
8. Define the x-range

The region lies between A and B , so $\frac{3}{2} \leq x \leq \frac{9}{2}$.

9. Define the lower boundary

The lower boundary is C_2 , so $y \geq \cos\left(\frac{\pi}{3}x\right)$.

10. Define the upper boundaries

The region is below both C_1 and the line segment L , so $y \leq \frac{9}{4} - (x - 3)^2$ and $y \leq -\frac{3}{2}x + \frac{27}{4}$.

Final answer

(a) $\frac{9}{4} - (x - 3)^2$.

(b) $P = (3, \frac{9}{4})$.

(c)(i) $x_B = \frac{9}{2}$.

(c)(ii) $k = \frac{\pi}{3}$.

(c)(iii) 6.

(d) $\frac{3}{2} \leq x \leq \frac{9}{2}$, $y \geq \cos(\frac{\pi}{3}x)$, $y \leq \frac{9}{4} - (x - 3)^2$, $y \leq -\frac{3}{2}x + \frac{27}{4}$.